

How to Make a Paper Glider

Easy start · Either · Kid can lead · Ages 5–9 · 20 min

Brought to you by Zech — “One sheet of paper. A hundred possibilities.”

Fold your own paper glider step by step, then test how it flies and map where it went. One sheet of paper, and a whole sky to chart.

WHAT YOU NEED

- 2 sheets of ordinary printer paper
- Markers or crayons
- A ruler if you want crisp folds

BEFORE YOU START

Fly the plane away from faces, pets, and windows.

Paper edges can give a papercut – press folds with a flat finger, not a fingernail.

How to make it

- 1 Fold one sheet in half the long way, then open it back up. That crease is your center line.
- 2 Fold the two top corners down to the center crease so they meet in a point.
- 3 Fold the whole pointed top down again to the center, then fold the plane in half along the first crease.
- 4 Fold each wing down so it lines up with the bottom edge. Press every crease firmly.
- 5 Throw it once. Watch where it goes: high, low, left, or right.
- 6 On the second sheet, draw the flight as a map. Mark the launch spot, the curve of the flight, and the landing zone.

TALK ABOUT IT

Your first throw did not go where you expected. What is one thing you would change about the plane before the next throw?

TRY THIS TOO

Add a paperclip to the nose and fly it again. Draw a second flight path on the same map in a different color, then compare the two.

DID YOU KNOW? · WEATHER & AIR

Wind is moving air. You cannot see air, but a paper airplane can. Air pushes back against the wings, and that push is what holds the plane up. When the plane dips or curves, it is showing you what the air is doing.